



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

adharmeṇa-edhate tāvat tato bhadraṇi paśyati | 4.174a
tataḥ sapatnān jayati sa.mūlas tu vinaśyati || 174 || 4.174c
satya.dharma.āryavṛtteṣu śauce ca-eva-āramet sadā | 4.175a
śiṣyāṃś ca śiṣyād dharmeṇa vāc.bāhu.udara.saṃyataḥ || 175 || 4.175c

— Manusmṛti, 4.1.16. Following the Path of Righteousness (Chapter 16), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The path of dharma, though sometimes appearing arduous, is ultimately the most rewarding. This passage from the Manusmṛti speaks to the deceptive nature of unrighteousness, reminding you that its initial prosperity is fleeting. It may seem that those who cut corners or act selfishly are thriving, but the scripture assures us that this is a temporary illusion. True and lasting success comes from adhering to dharma, which includes ethical conduct, truthfulness, and respect for others. The verse highlights that while adharma might bring temporary gains and victories, it ultimately leads to utter destruction, including the loss of inner peace and spiritual progress.

This destruction is described as being "sāmulam," meaning "with its roots." This suggests that unrighteousness not only destroys the immediate benefits but also eradicates the very foundation upon which future prosperity could be built. Conversely, the path of dharma, though it might seem slower or more challenging, builds a solid foundation for lasting happiness and fulfillment. The verses then emphasize the importance of truthfulness, righteousness, noble conduct, and purity, urging you to dedicate yourself to these qualities always. These are the cornerstones of a life lived in accordance with dharma.

The passage also emphasizes the role of a teacher, or anyone in a position of influence, to impart wisdom through self-discipline. A true teacher controls their speech, actions, desires, and appetite, setting an example for their students through their own embodiment of dharma. This highlights the significance of leading by example and the power of self-mastery in guiding others towards a righteous path.

In today's world, where instant gratification and material success are often prioritized, these verses offer a powerful reminder to look beyond the immediate and focus on long-term consequences. It encourages you to cultivate inner virtues and to act with integrity, even when it's difficult, knowing that these actions will ultimately lead to a more fulfilling and meaningful life. By embracing truth, righteousness, and purity, you can build a solid foundation for your own well-being and contribute to a more harmonious world.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you willing to forgo immediate gratification for the sake of long-term integrity and spiritual growth, and how can you embody these virtues in your daily interactions?